ONLY THE LONELY



Ex-CM and AIADMK rebel **O. Panneerselvam** (OPS) waited with the hope that PM Narendra Modi might toss him a lifeline during his Tamil Nadu visit. He didn't even get a handshake. With the main AIADMK shutting the door and the BJP looking the other way, his loyalists are now urging him to court actor Vijay's Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK). Whether he will be welcomed there will provide the next chapter in this fading saga.

Fists of Fury





Shiv Sena (Eknath Shinde faction) MLA **Sanjay Gaikwad,** who was recently caught on video assaulting staffers at the MLA's canteen in Mumbai, is now readying for some fisticuffs with ex-AIMIM MP **Imtiaz Jaleel**. The two had got into a verbal duel, after which a challenge was issued and accepted. The self-proclaimed tiger killer says he has made out a "stamp paper agreement" for the duel with Jaleel. Last we heard, though, saner counsel has prevailed, with Jaleel seeking a détente to focus on "development".

CABINET CHURN



Andhra Pradesh CM **N. Chandrababu Naidu** returns on July 31 after a five-day investments-chasing tour of Singapore, and his top priority, say sources, will be a cabinet reshuffle. 'Performance parameters' will weigh heavily on the six ministers (of the 24) likely to be dropped. Of course, "coalition dharma" will be a factor. Both the BJP and the Janasena Party, which have one and three ministers respectively, are likely to get an additional berth. These parties have eight and 21 MLAs while the TDP has 135 in the 175-seat assembly.

Kaushik Deka with Arkamoy Datta Majumdar, Kavitha Muralidharan, Dhaval S. Kulkarni, Avaneesh Mishra and Amarnath K. Menon

HEALTH WATCH

By **Sonali Acharjee**

CRYING CLUBS WEEPASANA CENTRES

A place to cry your heart out? Amid people you don't know. Well, that's exactly what the Mumbai Crying Club, launched just last week, will allow you to do. Nor is it the only one. You may not think of Surat as a city in need of emotional release, but it has had a Healthy Crying Club since 2017, where those in need of a good cry can do so once a month. Metropolitan cities like Delhi, Bengaluru and Hyderabad have taken their cue from the Japanese *rui-katsu*—communities that hold regular sob sessions—and have tear-sharing or vulnerability circles. But these are not formalised clubs, and exist only at the community level. "We encourage everyone to come and have a sob," says Shruti Rao, a resident of Whitefield in Bengaluru.

There is now evidence-based data to support the health and therapeutic benefits of shedding tears. For, it is not just an emotional response, but a 'biologically adaptive' one. Indeed, a 2019 study in cited in Pubmed says those who cried while watching emotional videos maintained more stable breathing, had a decelerated heart rate (before crying) and returned to baseline faster. This suggests that bursting a few sob bombs aid emotional regulation and physiological recovery. Several other studies have also confirmed that tears, especially emotional ones, 'contain stress hormones', and are a natural detox for mind and body. Hence the need for a safe space to release stress, emotions and mental burdens through collective crying.



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